

Student Finder Accommodation

Business Plan & Market Research and Feasibility Study

Business Plan Overview

Value Proposition

Student Finder Accommodation connects NSFAS-funded students with verified, NSFAS-accredited accommodation, solving the twin problems of scarce trustworthy listings and rampant rental scams.

Revenue Model

- Commission per successful booking from landlords
- Featured / promoted listing fees for landlords wanting greater visibility
- Premium verification badge fee for landlords (optional, or free initially to encourage adoption)
- Potential partnership or subsidy arrangement with universities or NSFAS itself for accredited listings

Market Research

Market Size Indicators

- South Africa has over 1 million NSFAS-funded students annually
- Chronic shortage of on-campus residences at most public universities forces the majority of students into private off-campus housing
- Rental scams targeting students are a widely reported, recurring problem each academic year

Competitor Landscape

- Existing platforms (Property24, PrivateProperty, Facebook groups) are general-purpose, with no NSFAS filtering or verification layer
- Student Finder Accommodation's gap in the market: no dominant player currently focuses specifically on NSFAS-accredited, scam-vetted student housing

Feasibility Study

Technical Feasibility

The prototype is achievable as a self-contained HTML/CSS/JavaScript site, presenting a low technical barrier appropriate for the coursework scope. Voice assistant functionality, AI-driven matching, and automated verification are realistic additions for a future development phase.

Economic Feasibility

The initial cost is low, as no backend infrastructure or hosting fees are required at the prototype phase. A commission-based revenue model requires no upfront fees from students, keeping the barrier to adoption low for the primary user group.

Operational Feasibility

A manual verification process is required initially to check landlord documents before the system can scale to automated checks. Partnerships with university housing offices could support onboarding and lend the platform additional legitimacy.

Prepared as supporting material for the Student Finder Accommodation coursework project — student accommodation booking platform for South African students.